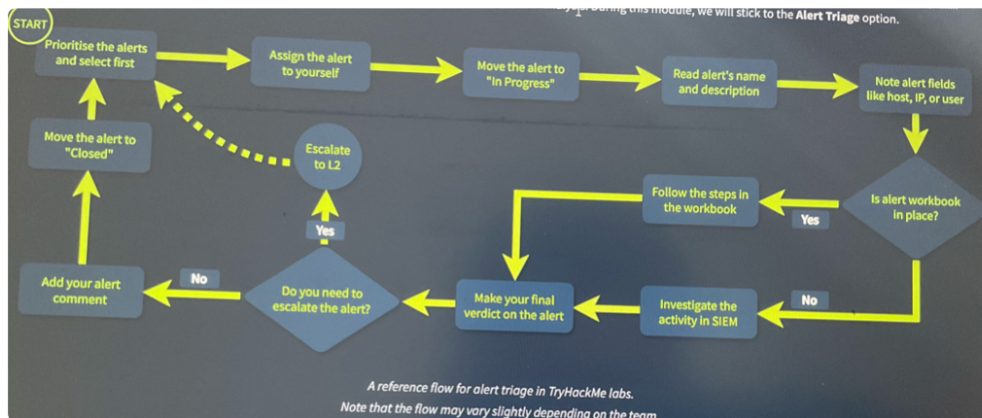


Task 5 :- Alert Triage

Finally, you are ready to review the chosen alert! The process is quite operational heavy, but you will soon see why every step is important. Also, note that alert review by SOC analysts can also be called alert triage, alert handling, alert processing, alert investigation or alert analysis. During this module we will stick to the Alert Triage option.



Initial Actions :- The initial steps are designed to ensure that you take ownership of assigned alerts and avoid interfering with alerts being handled by other analysts, and confirm that you are fully prepared to proceed with detailed investigation. You achieve it by first assigning to yourself, moving it to **In Progress**, and then familiarising yourself with alert details like its name, description and key indicator.

Investigation :-

This is the most complex step, requiring you to apply your technical knowledge and experience to understand the activity and properly analyse its legitimacy in SIEM or EDR logs.

To support L1 analysts with this step, some teams develop **workbooks** (also known as **playbooks** or **runbooks**) - instructions on how to investigate the specific category of alerts. If workbooks are not available, below are some key recommendations :-

1. Understand who is under threat, like affected user, hostname, cloud, network or website.
2. Note the action described the alert, like whether it was suspicious login, malware or phishing.
3. Review the surrounding events - looking for suspicious actions shortly before or after the alert.

4. use threat intelligence platforms or other available resources to verify your thoughts.

Final Actions: -

Your decisions here determine whether you found or missed potential cyberattack. Some actions like Escalation or commenting will be explained in following rooms, So don't worry if they sound complex right now. First decide if alert you investigated is malicious (True positive) or not (False positive). Then prepare detailed comment explaining your analysis steps and verdict reasoning, return to dashboard and move it to closed status.

SOC Dashboard Notes: -

If you didn't receive a flag after your triage, It means values you set are wrong.

You can reset the SOC dashboard by clicking Restart on top right in Try Hawk and SIEM.